



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Bethesda Christian School

School Website: <https://www.bethesdachristianschool.org/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**Overall Classification: CLASSICAL****Classicality Audit Report: Berean Christian Academy (Katy, TX)**

Website audited: <https://bereanchristianacademy.org>

**Executive Summary**

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Berean Christian Academy (BCA) presents strong, explicit commitments to the classical Christian tradition across mission, curriculum, and upper school pedagogy. The school names Truth, Goodness, and Beauty in its mission, frames theology as the “Queen of the Sciences,” organizes schooling by Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric, assigns Latin and Great Books, and culminates in a public Senior Thesis. Evidence of Socratic/Harkness discussion and debate is clear in the upper school. While explicit references to liturgical practices (e.g., daily chapel, hymnody) and a formal portrait of the teacher are less visible on public pages, the school’s memberships (ACCS, SCL) reinforce its classical identity. On balance, BCA’s public materials substantively align with the Six Essential Elements’ positive indicators.

Highlights - Mission explicitly names Truth, Goodness, Beauty and partnership with parents. - Curriculum structured by Trivium; Great Books, theology, philosophy, Latin; Senior Thesis capstone; Harkness/debate. - Theology framed as queen of the sciences; apologetics and Christian studies in sequence. - Affiliations: ACCS and SCL.

Method note: Keywords from BCA’s site were compared to the positive/negative indicators in Six Essential Elements and the companion lexicon to support each category rating.

**CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS**

What we looked for (per “Six Essential Elements”): transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty), theological grounding (theology/faith integration), and liturgical/communal practices (chapel, hymnody, prayer).

## 1) Keywords present in BCA materials

- Positive indicators found:
- “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty”; “Christ-centered worldview”; “disciples”; “wisdom” (mission/vision).
- “Theology as the Queen of Sciences”; apologetics; Christian studies sequence.
- Statement of Faith; Lord Jesus Christ.
- Liturgical/communal: No explicit website references found to daily chapel, hymnody, or school-wide liturgical rhythms in public pages reviewed.

## 2) Compare to Six Elements positive/negative lists

- Positive matches: truth, goodness, beauty; theology; Christian worldview; apologetics; wisdom (all positive keywords in the Religious/Metaphysical section).
- No evident negatives (e.g., “values-neutral,” “moral relativism”).

## 3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 10
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Sub□element coverage: 2 of 3 (moral realism + theological grounding are strong; liturgical practices not evidenced) → 0.67
- pos\_neg\_hits: +10/-0

## 4) Rating

- CLASSICAL. Strong transcendental/ theological language; missing explicit liturgy references keeps coverage below full.

**CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL**

What we looked for: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; education as formation; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty.

## 1) Keywords present

- “Recognize Truth, Goodness, and Beauty”; “disciples”; “walk in wisdom”; virtue development and mentorships.

## 2) Compare to indicators

- Positive matches: wisdom, virtue/virtue development, TGB, formation/disciple□making.
- No explicit negatives (e.g., “21st□century skills,” “college & career readiness” as telos).

## 3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 6
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage: ~0.90 (purpose statements and formation aims are explicit)
- pos\_neg\_hits: +6/-0

## 4) Rating

- CLASSICAL. Purpose is consistently formation in wisdom and virtue, oriented to TGB.

**CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM**

What we looked for: Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books/primary sources; integrated history (not “social studies”); cultivation of wonder.

## 1) Keywords present

- Trivium stages (Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric); Seven Liberal Arts.
- Great Books, original ancient texts; theology; philosophy; Latin III–VI; Spanish sequence.
- Debate, Harkness Table conversation; Senior Thesis capstone; explicit History by eras (Ancient/Medieval/Modern), not “social studies.”

## 2) Compare to indicators

- Positive matches: liberal arts, trivium, Latin, Great Books/primary texts, rhetoric, history by eras, theology/philosophy integration.
- No listed negatives like “social studies curriculum” replacing history.

## 3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 12
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage: 1.00 (all major curriculum signals present)
- pos\_neg\_hits: +12/-0

## 4) Rating

- CLASSICAL. Exemplary articulation of a classical, text-rich, trivium-oriented curriculum.

**CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS)**

What we looked for: restful learning/schol ; memory work (singing/chanting/recitation) in lower school; Socratic/seminar/debate in upper school; rhetoric practice/orations.

## 1) Keywords present

- Harkness Table conversation; formal logic and debate; Senior Thesis (public defense).
- Not observed: explicit “schol /restful learning,” “chanting/singing” language on public pages.

## 2) Compare to indicators

- Positive matches: Socratic-style seminar/discussion (Harkness), debate, rhetoric capstone.
- No negatives like “project-based learning dominance” or “student-directed/constructivist” emphasis.

## 3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 4
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage: ~0.50 (upper-school dialectic/rhetoric clearly evidenced; explicit lower-school memory/chanting or schol  not surfaced)
- pos\_neg\_hits: +4/-0

## 4) Rating

- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Clear upper-school dialectic/rhetoric strength; add visible references to schol  and memory work to reach full classical alignment on pedagogy.

**CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY**

What we looked for: teachers as models of virtue; mentorship/collegiality; “living curriculum”/portrait of a teacher/student.

## 1) Keywords present

- “Virtue development and mentorships” named as school distinctives (community-wide).
- Faculty qualifications (72% upper-school with advanced degrees) published.
- Not observed: explicit “teachers as models of virtue” language, “faculty of friends,” or a formal “portrait of a teacher/student” page.

## 2) Compare to indicators

- Partial positives for mentorship; limited explicit classical language about teachers as exemplars.
- No negatives.

## 3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 2
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage: ~0.40 (mentorship present; exemplar/portrait language not visible)
- pos\_neg\_hits: +2/-0

## 4) Rating

- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Add explicit faculty formation/virtue language and a published “portrait of a teacher.”

**CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS & COMMUNITY**

What we looked for: partnership with parents as co-educators; parent formation; parent access/hospitality.

## 1) Keywords present

- Mission states school “operates as a partnership between faculty and parents.”
- Prospective parent events; schedule a tour; admissions steps begin with “Discover Berean” and parent events.
- Community cadence (priority enrollment windows for current families).
- Not observed: explicit ongoing “parent formation” (e.g., book studies), or “parents welcome anytime” policy.

## 2) Compare to indicators

- Positive matches: parent partnership; regular parent events/visits.
- No negatives indicating minimal parent involvement.

## 3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 4
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage: ~0.67 (partnership + events; parent education and drop-in access not explicit)
- pos\_neg\_hits: +4/-0

## 4) Rating

- CLASSICAL. Strong partnership posture; publishing parent formation rhythms would further strengthen this area.

**Aggregate Classification**

- Category ratings: [1] CLASSICAL, [2] CLASSICAL, [3] CLASSICAL, [4] SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, [5] SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, [6] CLASSICAL.
- Overall: CLASSICAL.

Key evidence includes the mission centered on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; trivium and seven liberal arts structure; Great Books and original texts; Latin through advanced levels; logic, debate, Harkness, and Senior Thesis; and explicit classical associations (ACCS, SCL).

### What would move the needle (focused improvements)

Because Pedagogy and Faculty scored SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: - Pedagogy: Publish lower□school “memory work” practices explicitly (e.g., “singing, chanting, recitation” in K–6), and describe any scholé/restful learning rhythms. Showcases of oral recitations, catechesis, or hymnody would enhance visibility. - Faculty: Add a “Portrait of a Teacher” that names teachers as moral/intellectual exemplars who model the classical virtues; describe faculty formation in classical pedagogy and collegial seminars.

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### Evidence Appendix (select)

- Mission/partnership; TGB: BCA Mission and Vision.
  - Trivium, Great Books, Latin, Harkness, Senior Thesis; upper□school courses by era: School info and academic distinctives.
  - Theology as Queen of the Sciences; Mock Trial and Senior Thesis: Upper□school distinctives page.
  - ACCS and SCL memberships: Accreditation & memberships.
  - Parent events/tours: Admissions steps and Schedule a Tour.
  - Keyword standards used for evaluation: Six Essential Elements keyword lists and classicality lexicon.
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## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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